

If I had ... If we went ... etc.

A

Dan likes fast cars, but he doesn't have one.
He doesn't have enough money.

If he **had** the money, he **would buy** a fast car.

Usually **had** is *past*, but in this sentence **had** is *not past*. If he **had** the money = if he had the money *now* (but he doesn't have it).

If I had the money ...



DAN



If	I	had / knew / lived (etc.) ... ,	I	would ...
	you	didn't have / didn't know (etc.) ... ,	you	wouldn't ...
	it	were ... ,	it	could ...
	they	could ... ,	they	couldn't ...

You can say:

- ☐ If he **had** the money, he would buy a car.
- or He would buy a car **if he had** the money.

I'd / she'd / they'd etc. = I **would** / she **would** / they **would** etc. :

- ☐ I don't know the answer. **If I knew** the answer, **I'd tell** you.
- ☐ It's raining, so we're not going out. **We'd get** wet **if we went** out.
- ☐ Jane lives in a city. She likes cities. She **wouldn't be** happy **if she lived** in the country.
- ☐ **If you didn't have** a job, what **would** you **do**? (but you *have* a job)
- ☐ I'm sorry I can't help you. **I'd help** you **if I could**. (but I *can't*)
- ☐ **If we had** a car, we **could travel** more. (but we *don't* have a car, so we *can't* travel much)

B

If (I) **was/were** ...

You can say: **if I/he/she/it was** or
if I/he/she/it were

- ☐ It's not a very nice place. I wouldn't go there **if I were you**. (or ... **if I was** you)
- ☐ It would be nice **if the weather was** better.
(or ... **if the weather were** better)
- ☐ What would Tom do **if he were** here?
(or ... **if he was** here)

I wouldn't go out if I were you.



C

Compare:

if I have / if it is etc.

- ☐ I must go and see Helen.
If I have time, I **will go** today.
(= maybe I'll have time, so maybe I'll go)
- ☐ I like that jacket.
I'll buy it **if it isn't** too expensive.
(= maybe it will not be too expensive)
- ☐ **I'll help** you **if I can**. (= maybe I can)

if I had / if it was etc.

- ☐ I must go and see Helen.
If I had time, I **would go** today.
(= I don't have time today, so I will not go)
- ☐ I like this jacket, but it's very expensive.
I'd buy it **if it wasn't** so expensive.
(= it is expensive, so I'm not going to buy it)
- ☐ **I'd help** you **if I could**, but I can't.

Exercises

100.1 Complete the sentences.

- I don't know the answer. If I knew the answer, I'd tell you.
- I have a car. I couldn't travel very much if I didn't have a car.
- I don't want to go out. If I to go out, I'd go.
- We don't have a key. If we a key, we could get into the house.
- I'm not hungry. I would have something to eat if I hungry.
- Sue enjoys her work. She wouldn't do it if she it.
- He can't speak any foreign languages. If he speak a foreign language, perhaps he would get a better job.
- You don't try hard enough. If you harder, you would have more success.
- I have a lot to do today. If I so much to do, we could go out.

100.2 Put the verb in the correct form.

- If he had the money, he would buy a fast car. (he/have)
- Jane likes living in a city. She wouldn't be happy if she lived in the country. (she/not/be)
- If I wanted to learn Italian, to Italy. (I go)
- I haven't told Helen what happened. She'd be angry if (she/know)
- If a map, I could show you where I live. (we/have)
- What would you do if a lot of money? (you/win)
- It's not a very good hotel. there if I were you. (I/not/stay)
- If nearer London, we would go there more often. (we/live)
- It's a shame you have to go now. nice if you had more time. (it/be)
- I'm not going to take the job. I'd take it if better. (the salary/be)
- I don't know anything about cars. If the car broke down, what to do. (I/not/know)
- If you could change one thing in the world, what ? (you/change)

100.3 Complete the sentences. Choose from the box and put the verb in the correct form.

we (have) a bigger house	it (be) a bit cheaper
we (buy) a bigger house	the air (be) cleaner
we (have) some pictures on the wall	I (watch) it
every day (be) the same	I (be) bored

- I'd buy that jacket if it was a bit cheaper
- If there was a good film on TV tonight,
- This room would be nicer if
- If there wasn't so much traffic,
- Life would be boring if
- If I had nothing to do,
- We could invite all our friends to stay if
- If we had more money,

100.4 Complete the sentences. Use your own ideas.

- I'd be happier if I could get a better job
- If I could go anywhere in the world,
- I wouldn't be very happy if
- I'd buy if
- If I saw an accident in the street,
- The world would be a better place if